

The Playbook was supposed to be the elite business tablet, something the iPad wasn't at the time, but instead it didn't come with some of the most basic features essential for a corporate professional buying the tablet: no native email, calendar or contacts app. That was a mistake of epic proportions! What's more, unlike Android or iOS, the Playbook didn't have many third-party apps to choose from, and that squeezed out any remaining breath out of the device.

Notion Ink Adam

In the tablet era, few products can match the Notion Ink Adam's story. In the same year the original iPad was launched, imagine a startup announcing a tablet that was even more revolutionary and feature-packed than Apple's crown jewel. That's exactly what Rohan Shraavan's Bangalore-based Notion Ink did, teasing tablet enthusiasts around the world with a device so tantalizingly wonderful that it looked too good to be true. A lot of hype led to burgeoning public expectation and the result was a product that fell flat on its face and became embroiled in a controversy. Before it was unveiled at CES 2011, rumours began circulating that



Notion Ink Adam - too good to be true

Notion Ink's Adam had bitten off more than it could chew. The company took pre-orders for the tablet but deliveries were delayed due to production issues. What made matters worse is that Notion Ink refused to speak to the media (including us) during this critical phase of its young entrepreneurial life, and ended up losing all credibility.

Apple Ping

Social media web sites are vast, broad-based online properties for one simple reason: to attract a lot of people. So the idea of a social

network only for iTunes users to discuss their love of music seemed ludicrous, not to mention myopic and lacking foresight. The same people were doing similar things more easily on Facebook! So it was no surprise that Apple's Ping social media attempt was ruthlessly beheaded and killed earlier this month. May it rest in peace and never resurface!

Microsoft Kin phones

Long before Microsoft got its smartphone act together, and had no clue how to attack Apple's lead in the smartphone market, it launched Kin. There were two models up for grabs, Kin ONE and Kin TWO. The phones were supposed to be for youngsters hooked onto social networks, and an important project within the company trying to attract Gen Y with close to US \$1 billion riding on its success. Success was too busy in bed with the Apple iPhone though, and the Kin phones were a resounding failure (our opinion), for they were sold in the market for just over a month before production stopped and it was officially declared a failure (industry opinion). This failure cost Steve Ballmer, Microsoft CEO, half of his annual bonus. We'll bet he wasn't jumping up and down excitedly that tax year.

Google Wave

Even to this day, no one really knows what Google Wave was. Sure, you can watch the Google tutorials – but if your head doesn't spin after the first few minutes, you aren't watching it properly, or probably dozing off in boredom mixed with confusion. Google Wave was heralded as a “real-time messaging platform” (whatever that means!) when it was unveiled back in May 2009. Sergey Brin, co-founder of Google, went as far as to say that Wave would “set a new benchmark

for interactivity.” Maybe he was referring to fellow Googlers, and not the general public, when Brin spoke about Google Wave. Sporting an interface that was a mish-mash of Twitter, Gmail and real-time documents editing in Google Docs, no wonder users logged in, got the living daylight scared out of them, and never decided to come back to give it another chance. Ahead of its time or not, Google Wave was definitely confusing.

Google Buzz

While talking about Wave, it's difficult to leave out Buzz, another one of Google's rare slip-ups. When Google hadn't quite announced full-fledged war on Facebook, and while it was still too busy being a search engine giant, it woke up and realised that it lacked a compelling social network service in its umbrella of products (They forgot about Orkut we suppose). Thus Buzz was born back in February 2010, hoping to champion Google's social cause against the likes of Twitter and Facebook. But before Google's proverbial social silver bullet had left the barrel, it had become a privacy breach for hundreds of early users of the service. Google faced a lot of negative press and angry users, and critics ridiculed Buzz as a mere afterthought by Google. And Facebook was on its way to world domination!

iPhone 4 Antennagate

For Apple, the year 2010 holds bittersweet memories – the original iPad was launched that year, and the world also had to witness the iPhone 4 Antennagate. Soon after the iPhone 4 went on sale in June, a lot of users and web sites started reporting the phone losing signal when held on its antenna band. All the irate iPhone 4 users complaining about the phone's reception woes provoked an amusing response from the late Steve Jobs – he simply said that everyone was holding the phone the wrong way! The problem refused to go away even after Apple released a software update, hoping to fix it. At this point, deathgrip had become a household term in the U.S., and Nokia and Motorola had ridiculed Apple iPhone 4's antenna woes in two of its own smartphone campaigns. Steve Jobs, in a press conference, defended iPhone 4's design and said the deathgrip problem was industry-wide, and promised iPhone 4 users a free bumper case to amplify the phone's signal reception. And while all this was happening, tech media and readers couldn't stop laughing. 



Google Wave – waves goodbye maybe